know I'm still going to eat the lot. But at least in this case 'the lot' is only two squares, not an entire block of chocolate. That's because the amount provided to me has been regulated. My self-control remains the same, but my environment has been changed because of the habit I've implemented which minimises what is consumed.

Setting up a basic financial system is the first step in helping you establish self-control by regulating your environment through the financial habits you implement. It includes multiple bank accounts and automatically transferring payments into different accounts with rules that guide how those payments are to be spent. It's a financial version of 'out of sight and out of mind' and it means you're financially hiding the whole block of chocolate while giving yourself two squares for now. Plus, it gives you permission to enjoy what's in front of you without guilt, knowing you're effectively exercising great self-control through the plan you have in place and the financial environment you've created.

Before we go too much further, though, we need to briefly talk about goals. Now, depending on your Money Type and Money Story, you might be tempted to skip past here. Workers might be tempted to jump straight to action because they want to start doing something. Those who have a Money Story that says they won't amount to much or that they are not enough might be tempted to skip because they don't believe that any goal they'll set is capable of being realised. For both, it's important to honour and acknowledge that thinking but to actively reject it.

Here's the reason why you shouldn't skip past goal-setting, regardless of your Money Story or Type. The question I'm most commonly asked is: 'How much should I save?' Some experts might tell you that amount should be 20 per cent of your income. Why? Who knows. I'm sure it's based on economic theory, average wages and so on, but for so many people it's wrong. The real answer should be: 'It depends'. It depends on how old you are, what you're saving for, whether you're still living at home with parents and not paying rent, what your lifestyle goals are, when you want to stop working, whether you're paying for dependants and so much more. Your goals will be as unique as your Financial Phenotype, and they should be. They shouldn't be your parents', peers' or society's goals—they should be exclusively yours.